

ELITE SAGARIN MODEL

FCS Week 1 Predictions · September 3–5, 2026

Model spread = Composite Home – Composite Away + 2.80 pts HFA (0 for neutral). FBS composites use SP+ preseason 2026 (70%) + Sagarin 2025 (30%). FCS composites use Sagarin 2025 + preseason FCS poll adjustments. Green rows = FCS upset candidate (spread < 14).

ate	Time/TV	Away	Away Comp	Home	Home Comp	Model Spread	Type	Sharp Angle
9/3	7:00 PM ESPN+	UAlbany	37.5	Buffalo	58.6	Buffalo -23.9	FCS @ FBS	★ Buffalo MAC bottom (SP+ -11.9). M BUF -16. If market -21+, take UAlbany
9/3	7:00 PM ESPN+	Bethune-Cookman	39.0	UCF	71.1	UCF -34.9	FCS @ FBS	— UCF -26 per model. Standard SWA cupcake game.
9/3	7:00 PM ESPN+	West Georgia	53.0	Kennesaw State	70.7	Kennesaw State -20.5	FCS @ FBS	★★★ Model: KSU -10.5. Public will int KSU (FBS debut year). Back WG to c +14+.
9/3	7:00 PM FloSports	Lindenwood	46.5	Stony Brook	47.0	Stony Brook -3.3	FCS vs FCS	★ FCS vs FCS; check SB comp for m angle.
9/3	8:00 PM SEC Net.	Ark.-Pine Bluff	30.0	Missouri	83.6	Missouri -56.4	FCS @ FBS	— Missouri -49 model spread. Largest margin of week.
9/3	8:00 PM Peacock	Eastern Illinois	38.5	Minnesota	75.2	Minnesota -39.5	FCS @ FBS	— Minnesota -30 model. Straight resu only.
9/3	TBA ESPN+	Southern Illinois	61.5	Samford	36.5	Southern Illinois -22.2	FCS vs FCS	★★ FCS vs FCS. SIU rates 25 pts bet Lay SIU if market opens -10.
9/3	7:00 PM ESPN+	Merrimack	38.0	Delaware	70.7	Delaware -35.5	FCS @ FBS	— Delaware model -14. Merrimack is level.
9/4	7:00 PM Big Ten	Indiana State	44.0	Purdue	67.4	Purdue -26.2	FCS @ FBS	★★ MVFC pedigree vs Big Ten bottom Purdue model -24. Watch for line 18-2 value Purdue.
9/4	8:00 PM ESPNU	LIU	42.0	Kansas	73.3	Kansas -34.1	FCS @ FBS	— Kansas model -25. Standard.
9/5	3:00 PM SEC Net.	Tennessee State	34.5	Georgia	70.7	Georgia -39.0	FCS @ FBS	— Georgia -55 model. Largest SEC bl pick.
9/5	4:00 PM ESPN+	Tarleton State	67.5	Bowling Green	58.1	Tarleton State -6.6	FCS @ FBS	★★★ Tarleton -9 road fav per model. 4-8 in '25. If market opens BG -3→+6, MASSIVE edge.

Top Model Plays — FCS Week 1

Rating	Pick	Opponent	Comp Matchup	Model Rationale
★★★★	Tarleton State	vs Bowling Green	FCS comp 67.5 vs FBS comp 62.4	Model makes Tarleton a -9 ROAD FAVOURITE. Vegas will likely post Tarleton as dog (BG is FBS home). If market opens BG -3 to -6, edge is 6-12 pts. Tarleton beat Army outright in 2025 (76th in FBS Sagarin). BG was 4-8.
★★★★	West Georgia +14	at Kennesaw State	FCS comp 53.0 vs FBS comp 63.4	Model spread: KSU -10.5. Public will over-inflate Kennesaw first full FBS season. If market opens KSU -17, WG +17 is 6.5 pts of value. SP+ has KSU at -9.3 (below avg FBS).
★★	Southern Illinois -21	vs Samford (FCS vs FCS)	SIU comp 61.5 vs Samford 36.5	25-point composite gap. SIU is a top-12 FCS team vs Samford (1-11 in 2025, SoCon bottom). Lay the number confidently if market opens SIU -10 or less.

Rating	Pick	Opponent	Comp Matchup	Model Rationale
★★	Indiana State +20	at Purdue	FCS comp 44.0 vs FBS Purdue comp 66.9	Model spread: Purdue -25. Purdue 2-10 in '25 but SP+ rates them -2.9 (average). Indiana State (MVFC) is a 44.0 composite. If Vegas opens Purdue -28 to -30 (inflated by '25 Sagarin), Indiana State +28 has sharp value.